A Living Research Record: Version-Controlled Experiment Trees with Frozen Nodes

Every experiment is a node; the paper is the projection

Daniel Ari Friedman
Active Inference Institute
daniel@activeinference.institute
ORCID: 0000-0001-6232-9096
DOI: forthcoming

November 9, 2026

Contents

1 Abstract **2**

2 Introduction **3**

3 Methodology **4**

4 Results **5**
4.1 Answered nodes 5
4.2 Winners per round 5

5 Dead ends and discussion **6**
5.1 In progress (frozen preregistrations) 6

6 References **7**

1 Abstract

This living record tracks 3 experiments organized as a version-controlled tree with frozen nodes. Of these, 0 are answered (0 wins, 0 dead ends), 1 are frozen preregistrations, and 2 are provisional plans. The paper you are reading is generated from the tree state; answering or freezing a node regenerates it.

2 Introduction

Research logs rot because outcomes live in notebooks while plans live in issue trackers. We propose the opposite coupling: a single experiment tree where nodes are preregistered (frozen) before being run, and the manuscript is a deterministic projection of that tree. The tree carries a run_command contract per node, so every recorded experiment names the canonical command that produced its evidence.

3 Methodology

Each node carries a status from the ladder {provisional, frozen, answered}. A provisional node may be frozen (preregistered, immutable) or answered directly. Answering a frozen node is refused by construction: preregistered commitments may not be back-filled. Within one tree, each run_command may be declared by at most one node, so an experiment identity maps one-to-one onto the command that runs it.

4 Results

4.1 Answered nodes

No answered experiments yet.

4.2 Winners per round

{}

5 Dead ends and discussion

Negative results are first-class: every answered node with outcome `dead_end` is registered below, keeping future rounds away from retired directions.

No dead ends recorded.

5.1 In progress (frozen preregistrations)

- E003: Frozen preregistration: momentum follow-up

6 References

See `references.bib` for the bibliography (rendered by Pandoc).